

E-Choupal

It is an India-based business initiative by ITC (India Tobacco Company) Limited that provides internet access to rural farmers. The purpose is to inform and empower them and, as a result to improve the quality of agricultural goods and the quality of life for farmers. ITC Limited is a consumer product and agribusiness conglomerate in India known for their production of cigarettes, speciality paper, food products and packaging services.

Mobile Governance

Mobile Government or m-Government, is the extension of e-Government to mobile platforms and also the strategic use of government services and applications which are only possible using cellular/mobile telephones, laptop computers, Personal Digital Assistants (PDAs) and wireless internet infrastructure.

E-Courts

The e-Courts project was conceptualised on the basis of the 'National Policy and Action Plan for Implementation of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) in the Indian Judiciary 2005' submitted by e-Committee (Supreme Court of India), with a vision to transform the

Indian Judiciary by ICT enablement of Courts. Such e-court was established first time in Hyderabad High Court on 18th July, 2016.

Official Languages (Articles 343-351)

Article 343 mentions that the official language of the Union shall be Hindi in Devanagari script. Article 348 mentions that English will be language to be used in the Supreme Court and in the high courts and for acts, bills, etc. This part is related to the **official languages**, promotion of Hindi as well as mother tongues at least in primary education.

Amendment

- An Amendment (Article 368) of the Constitution can be initiated only by the introduction of a bill for purpose in either House of Parliament and not in the State Legislatures.
- The bill can be introduced either by a minister or by a private member and does not require prior permission of the President.
- Each house must pass the bill separately. No provision of joint setting.

IMPORTANT CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENTS

An amendment to the Constitution can be initiated in either House of the Parliament and there is no provision of joint session here. President has to, under all conditions, provide his consent to such a bill. He cannot withhold his assent nor can he return it.

- **1st Amendment, 1951** to overcome certain practical difficulties related to Fundamental Rights. Also added 9th Schedule (Act and Regulation), Land Reform Act.
- **7th Amendment, 1956** necessitated on account of reorganisation of states on linguistic basis and introduced changes in the 1st and 4th Schedule.
- **9th Amendment, 1960** gave effect to transfer certain territories to Pakistan following the 1958 Indo-Pak agreement.
- **10th Amendment, 1961** incorporated Dadra and Nagar Haveli in India.
- **12th Amendment, 1962** incorporated Goa, Daman and Diu in India.
- **13th Amendment, 1962** created Nagaland as a state.
- **14th Amendment, 1963** incorporated Puducherry in India from France.
- **18th Amendment, 1966** reorganised Punjab into Punjab, Haryana and UT of Chandigarh.
- **27th Amendment, 1971** established Manipur and Tripura as states and Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh as UT.
- **31st Amendment, 1973** increased the elective strength of Lok Sabha from 525 to 545. The upper limit of representatives of state went up from 500 to 525.
- **42nd Amendment, 1976** provided supremacy of Parliament and gave primacy to Directive Principles over Fundamental Rights. It also added 10 Fundamental Duties to the Constitution. The Preamble of the Constitution was also altered to 'Sovereign', 'Socialist', 'Secular' and 'Democratic Republic'. It is also called **Mini Constitution**.
- **44th Amendment, 1978** restored the normal duration of the Lok Sabha and Legislative Assembly to 5 years. The **Right to Property** was deleted from Part III. Also limited the power of the government to proclaim internal emergency. The national emergency shall not be proclaimed except on the written recommendation of the Cabinet.
- **52nd Amendment, 1985** 10th Schedule was added through this (Anti-Defection Law).
- **61st Amendment, 1989** reduced the voting age from 21 to 18 years for the Lok Sabha as well as Assemblies.
- **62nd Amendment, 1989** extended reservation of seats for SC/ST till AD 2000.
- **69th Amendment, 1991** accorded a special status to the Union Territory of Delhi as a National capital territory of Delhi.
- **70th Amendment** proposed to grant statehood to Delhi.

- **73rd Amendment, 1992** (Panchayati Raj) to provide among other things Gram Sabha in villages, Constitution of Panchayats at the village and other levels, direct elections to all seats in Panchayats and reservation of seats for the SC and ST and fixing of tenure of 5 years for Panchayats.
- **74th Amendment, 1992** (Nagar Palika) To provide for, among other things, Constitution of three types of municipalities, reservation of seats in every municipality for the SC and ST, women and the backward classes.
- **76th Amendment Act, 1994** It provides reservation in educational institutions and posts in state services.
- **84th Amendment, 2001** Creation of the new states of Chhattisgarh, Uttaranchal and Jharkhand.
- **86th Amendment, 2002** Article 21 (A), which makes primary education a Fundamental Right to children between age of 6-14 years was added.
 - **Article 45** of Directive Principle.
 - 11th Fundamental Duties were added through this.
- **91st Amendment, 2003** The provision of 10th Schedule (Anti-Defection Law) pertaining to exemption from disqualification in case of split of 1/3rd member of the legislature party has been deleted. It means that defectors have no more protection on grounds of splits.
- **92nd Amendment Act, 2003** Four languages were added in 8th Schedule—Bodo, Dogri, Maithili and Santhali.
- **93rd Amendment** Added clause (5) to Article 15 making special provisions for advancement of any socially and educationally backward classes.
- **94th Amendment, 2006** To provide for a Minister of Tribal Welfare in newly created Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh states and deletion of Bihar's name.
- **95th Amendment, 2010** To extend the reservation of seats for SCs and STs in the Lok Sabha and States Assemblies from 60 to 70 years.
- **96th Amendment, 2011** Substituted 'Odia' for 'Oriya'.
- **97th Amendment, 2012** To give right to form co-operative societies and give a framework for their working.
- **98th Amendment, 2013** To empower the Governor of Karnataka to take steps to develop the Hyderabad-Karnataka region.
- **99th Amendment, 2014** National Judicial Appointments Commission was established. But on 16th October, 2015 Supreme Court struck down the NJAC as unconstitutional.
- **100th Amendment, 2015** To the acquiring of territories by India and transfer of territories to Bangladesh in pursuance of the agreements and its protocol between India and Bangladesh.
- **101st Amendment, 2016** It is related to goods and services tax.

> PRACTICE EXERCISE

1. Which of the following provisions were made in the Charter Act of 1833?

1. The commercial functions of the East India Company came to an end and now it had only political functions.
2. Government services in India were thrown open to all Indians.
3. The designation of the Governor-General of Bengal was changed as the Governor-General of British India.
4. An Indian was to be appointed as a Law Member in the Governor-General's council.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 3 and 4

2. Which of the following pairs are not correctly matched?

1. Government of India : Dyarchy Act, 1919
2. Government of India : Provincial autonomy Act, 1335
3. Minto-Morley Reforms : Separate electorate
4. Mountbatten Plan : Constituent Assembly
5. Cabinet Mission Plan, : Partition of India 1946

Codes

- (a) 4 and 5 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 5 (d) 2 and 3

3. Which of the following are among the provisions of the Act of 1858?

1. The administration of India and the Indian Territories was transferred to the Crown.
2. The East India Company was abolished.
3. The Governor-General of India was to be known as the Viceroy of India and a Secretary of State for India was also appointed.
4. The administrative power of India was to be shared between the East India Company and the Crown of England.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) All of these

4. Consider the following statement(s)

1. Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs constitute Consultative Committees of Members of both the Houses of Parliament.
2. The main purpose of these Committees are to provide a forum for formal discussions between the Government and Members of Parliament on policies and programmes of the Government.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

5. Which of the following pairs is incorrectly matched?

- (a) 9th December, 1947 : Constituent Assembly's first meeting
- (b) 26th November, 1949 : The people of India adopted, enacted and gave to themselves the Constitution
- (c) 24th January, 1950 : The Constitution was finally signed by the members of the Constituent Assembly
- (d) 26th January, 1950 : The date of commencement the Constitution

6. Match the following

List I	List II
A. Bill of Rights and Judicial Review	1. England
B. Parliamentary system of Democracy	2. Ireland
C. Directive Principles	3. USA
D. Residuary powers with the centre	4. Canada

Codes

- A B C D A B C D
(a) 4 1 2 3 (b) 1 2 3 4
(c) 3 4 2 1 (d) 3 1 2 4

7. Who among the following were the members of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution?

1. KM Munshi
2. Jawaharlal Nehru
3. Alladi Krishnaswami Ayyar
4. Sardar Patel

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2, 3 and 4

8. Match the following

List I	List II
A. Establishment of Board of Control	1. Regulating Act, 1773
B. Establishment of Supreme Court	2. Pitt's India Act, 1784
C. Christian missionaries were allowed to spread their religion in India	3. Charter Act, 1813
D. Governor General of Bengal as Governor General of India	4. Charter Act, 1833

Codes

- A B C D A B C D
(a) 1 2 3 4 (b) 2 1 3 4
(c) 1 2 4 3 (d) 2 4 1 3

9. Consider the following statements about the Government of India Act, 1935 provide for

1. the provincial autonomy.
2. the establishment of federal court.
3. all India Federation at the Centre.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) All of these

10. Consider the following statement(s)

1. The Charter Act, 1853 abolished East India company's monopoly of Indian trade.
2. Under the Government of India Act, 1858, the British Parliament abolished the East India Company altogether and undertook the responsibility of ruling India directly.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

11. Which one of the following Schedules of the Constitution of India includes the disqualification of a Legislator on grounds of defection?

- (a) 8th Schedule
(b) 7th Schedule
(c) 5th Schedule
(d) 10th Schedule

- 12.** Which one of the following statements regarding the Speaker is correct?
- He holds office during the pleasure of the President
 - He need not be a Member of the House at the time of his election, but has to become a Member of the House within six months from the date of his election
 - He loses his office, if the House is dissolved before the end of its normal tenure
 - If, he intends to resign the letter of his resignation is to be addressed to the President
- 13.** The Indian Parliamentary system is different from the British Parliamentary system, in that India has
- both real and nominal executive
 - a system of collective responsibility
 - bicameral legislation
 - the system of judicial review
- 14.** Which of the following is a basic feature of the Presidential Government?
- Rigid Constitution
 - Single Executive
 - Supremacy of the Legislature
 - Residual powers of the State
- 15.** Which of the following is the common features of a Federal Constitution?
- A written and rigid Constitution.
 - Division of power between the centre.
 - Separation of powers between the Legislature and Executive.
 - Bicameral National Legislature.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.*
- 2, 3 and 4
 - 1, 3 and 4
 - 1, 2 and 4
 - All of these

16. Match the following

List I (Features of the Indian Constitution)	List II (Borrowed from)
A. Fundamental Rights	1. UK
B. Parliamentary System of Government	2. USA
C. Emergency provisions	3. Ireland
D. Directive Principle of State Policy	4. Germany

Codes

	A	B	C	D		A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	3	1	(b)	2	1	3	4
(c)	2	1	4	3	(d)	1	2	4	3

- 17.** Who among the following have the office of the Vice-President of India?
- Mohammed Hidayatullah
 - Fakh-ru-ddin Ali Ahmed
 - Neelam Sanjiva Reddy
 - Shankar Dayal Sharma
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.*
- 3 and 4
 - 1 and 4
 - 2 and 3
 - All of these
- 18.** Which of the following taxes is/are levied by the Union and collected and appropriated by states?
- Stamp Duties
 - Passenger and Goods Tax
 - Estate Duty
 - Taxes on Newspapers
- 19.** Which of the following can be termed 'Gandhian' among the Directive Principles?
- Prevention of cow slaughter.
 - Promotion of cottage industries.
 - Establishment of Village Panchayats.
 - Uniform civil code for the country.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.*
- 1 and 2
 - 1, 2 and 3
 - 1 and 3
 - All of these
- 20.** Among the 'Socialistic' Directive Principles may be listed
- prevention of concentration of wealth.
 - right to work.
 - separation of judiciary from executive.
 - organising agriculture along scientific lines.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.*
- 1 and 2
 - 1, 2 and 3
 - 2 and 4
 - All of these
- 21.** What is meant by saying that the Directive Principle of State Policy are non-justiciable?
- In case they are violated, the matter cannot be taken to the court.
 - Courts are debarred from consideration of Directive Principles.
 - The law of the land does not recognise the existence.
 - They are sacrosanct.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.*
- 1 and 2
 - Only 1
 - 1, 2 and 3
 - All of these

22. What are the Gandhian principles incorporated in the Indian Constitution?

- Efforts to be made for the development for weaker or backward sections of the society.
- Prohibition on the use of intoxicating liquor except for medicinal purposes.
- Organisation of Village Panchayats.
- Establishment of cottage and small-scale industries in rural areas.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- 1, 3 and 4
- 1, 2 and 3
- 2, 3 and 4
- All of these

23. Which of the following are a Directive Principle of State Policy?

- Equal pay for equal work for men and women.
- Equal right to an adequate means of livelihood.
- Abolition of untouchability.
- Just and human condition of work.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- Only 3
- 1, 2 and 4
- 1, 2 and 3
- All of these

24. Consider the following statement(s)

- The Union Executive consists of the President and the Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister as the head.
- The President may, by writing under his hand addressed to the Vice-President, resign his office.
- Executive power of the Union is vested in the Prime Minister.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- 1 and 3
- 2 and 3
- Only 2
- All of these

25. Which of the following determines that the Indian Constitution is federal?

- A written and rigid Constitution
- An Independent Judiciary
- Vesting of residuary power with the centre
- Distribution of powers between centre and states

26. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

- Amendment Procedure : Article 268
- Duties of Prime Minister : Article 74
- President's Rule : Article 365
- Inter-State Council : Article 263

27. Which of the following authorities recommends the principles governing the grant in aid of revenues to states out of consolidated fund of India?

- (a) Finance Commission
- (b) Planning Commission
- (c) Union Ministry of Finance
- (d) Inter-State Council

28. The Parliament can legislate on any subject in the State List.

- 1. If, the Rajya Sabha declares by a 2/3rd majority resolution that it is expedient to do so in national interest.
- 2. For the implementation of international treaties.
- 3. If, two or more states make a request to Parliament to do so.
- 4. When Article 356 is imposed in the state.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 1, 3 and 4
- (c) 1, 2 and 4
- (d) All of these

29. Which of the following statement(s) is/are stated in the Constitution of India?

- 1. The President shall not be a member of either Houses of Parliament.
- 2. The Parliament shall consist of the President and two houses.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

30. Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct?

- 1. The Directive Principle are meant to establish Political Democracy.
- 2. The Directive Principle are meant to establish Social Democracy.
- 3. The Directive Principle is meant to establish Economic Democracy.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) All of these

31. Which of the following statement(s) is/are correct?

- 1. Fundamental Rights enjoy legal supremacy over Directive Principles.
- 2. Right to Education is available to foreigners in India.

3. Right to Information is available only for citizen to the citizens of India.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1 and 2
- (d) All of these

32. Which of the following provisions of the Constitution of India have a bearing on Education?

- 1. Directive Principles of State Policy.
- 2. Rural and Urban Local Bodies.
- 3. 5th Schedule.
- 4. 6th Schedule.
- 5. 7th Schedule.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 3, 4 and 5
- (c) 1, 2 and 5
- (d) All of these

33. Under which one of the following Constitution Amendment Acts, four languages were added to the languages under the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution of India, thereby raising their number to 22?

- (a) Constitution (90th Amendment) Act
- (b) Constitution (91st Amendment) Act
- (c) Constitution (92nd Amendment) Act
- (d) Constitution (93rd Amendment) Act

34. Consider the following statements

- 1. The Speaker of Lok Sabha has the power to adjourn the House sine die but, on prorogation, it is only the President, who can summon the house.
- 2. Unless sooner dissolved or there is an extension of the term, there is an automatic dissolution of the Lok Sabha by efflux of time, at the end of the period of 5 years, even if no formal order of dissolution is issued by the President.
- 3. The Speaker of Lok Sabha continues in office even after the dissolution of the house and until 'immediately before the first meeting of the house'.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) All of these

35. Which of the following are the methods of Parliamentary control over public finance in India?

- 1. Placing Annual Financial Statement before the Parliament.

2. Withdrawal of moneys from Consolidated Fund of India only after passing the Appropriation Bill.

- 3. Provisions of supplementary grants and vote-on-account.
- 4. A periodic or atleast a mid-year review of programme of the Government against macro-economic forecast and expenditure by a Parliamentary Budget Office.
- 5. Introducing Finance Bill in the Parliament.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 5
- (b) 1, 2 and 4
- (c) 3, 4 and 5
- (d) All of these

36. Consider the following statements

- 1. While members of the Rajya Sabha are associated with Committees on Public Accounts and Public Undertakings, members of Committee on Estimates are drawn entirely from Lok Sabha.
- 2. The Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs works under the overall direction of Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs.
- 3. The Minister of Parliamentary Affairs nominates Members of Parliament on Committees, Councils, Boards and Commissions etc set up by the Government of India in the various ministries.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 1 and 3
- (d) All of these

37. Which of the following special powers have been conferred on the Rajya Sabha by the Constitution of India?

- (a) To change the existing territory of a state and to change the name of a state
- (b) To pass a resolution empowering the Parliament to make laws in the State List and to create one or more all India Services
- (c) To amend the election procedure of the President and to determine the pension of the President after his/her retirement
- (d) To determine the functions of the Election Commission and to determine the number of Election Commissioners

38. Consider the following statement(s)

- 1. The Rajya Sabha alone has the power to declare that it would be in national interest for the Parliament to legislate with respect to a matter in the State List.